

pletely powered-off but the present state is saved, so that when the laptop is started the next time, it's as if you had only suspended it. This mode is helpful when you want to completely shut-off the laptop (for example, when passing it through airport security checks), but do not wish to reload all your open documents and Web pages.

If you have to temporarily leave your desk, you can choose to lock the desktop with the help of a screen password or just put the lid down. Usually, when you put the lid down while the computer is on, it goes into 'Suspend' mode. This setting can be changed to just activate the screensaver instead, so that you can quickly resume your work after coming back to your workstation. Some of you may prefer to have the network connection running while you just walk across the office or take a short break. Activating the screensaver along with locking the desktop has the advantage that no one can pry into your work and documents while you are away.

Cable lock

Most of the laptops these days come with a socket to attach a cable lock. The



cable can be attached to an immovable object, like a loop in a desk that's meant for power cables to run down to their sockets. The cables are usually very strong and cannot be broken easily. Attaching such a cable ensures no one can steal the laptop. This can be very useful in physically securing the laptop at conferences, hotel rooms and cars.

Brightness adjustment

The brightness of your laptop screens can be adjusted via key combinations that vary from manufacturer to manufacturer. The brightness can be adjusted to suit the ambient light, in order to be easy on the eyes. If you are seated in a very bright place, you may want to set the brightness levels of the screen to higher levels for easy readability. On the other hand, in low brightness conditions, the laptop's brightness can be tuned down, so the screen is not too bright and doesn't strain the eyes.

Also, when you're running out of battery power but want to give that one last touch to the presentation, you can dim the brightness levels to prolong the battery's life.

Keyboard lights

Some manufacturers also include a bulb that shines lightly on the keys, or the keys have a backlight so they are illuminated. This bulb or backlight can be enabled or disabled via function keys, which is laptop-dependent. This is helpful to locate keys in low-light conditions. Besides, as trained typists are aware, the 'F' and 'J' keys are physically different to the touch. Both have raised lines below the letters, making it easy for those typing in poor light to



orient themselves to the keyboard. This feature is universally adopted to make keyboards more user-friendly for the visually handicapped.

Multimedia keys

The multimedia keys can be used to play, pause or stop audio and video content. There are also keys to skip to the next audio or video item in play-



lists. You can also mute and adjust volume levels. These keys are useful while delivering presentations or for quickly controlling the playback of audio-visual content, without having to search for the application that's playing audio, and selecting the appropriate buttons on that particular application's menu. ●

The author has been using computers for about 20 years now and makes extensive use of features offered by laptops by turning them to his liking. This article is reproduced from EFY's Benelli magazine

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